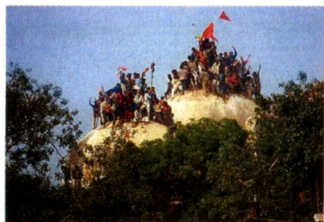


THE MAIN EVENT

Babri Masjid Demolished



PRASHANT PANJIAR : www.indiatodayimages.com

A FRENZIED MOB HACKS AWAY AT THE DOMES OF THE BABRI MASJID

The scenes will return, like deranged ghosts, to haunt those of us who were at the graveside to witness the burial of a secular dream. The screams of exultation with each blow of a pickaxe, each thrust of a rod, each dome that came crashing down. If there were no implements, the frenzied hordes would have used their bare hands to the same effect, so powerful was the poison that coursed through their veins in those few hours of madness. But even at the dawn of that Barbaric Sunday, few among the moderates or even the large media contingent believed that before sundown, and in the space of a few hours, the triple domes that loomed so securely on the horizon would be razed to the ground.

India Today, December 31, 1992

ALSO

- The RSS, VHP, Bajrang Dal, Jamaat-e-Islami Hind and Islamic Sevak Sangh are banned
- Satyajit Ray gets an Oscar for Lifetime Achievement
- The ASLV and satellite INSAT 2A are launched

|1992| EARTH SUMMIT

The Eco Woodstock

The Parliament of the Planet falters as the rich and the poor battle

It was billed as the "Parliament of the Planet" and the greatest collective gathering of world leaders to save the earth. Even the legendary Fidel Castro of Cuba showed that his years in the jungle as a guerilla leader had also made him a great environmentalist by delivering a sterling speech that George Bush Sr, the then US President, had to applaud. The 1992 Earth Summit at the Brazilian resort of Rio De Janeiro was unique in many other ways. It was the Woodstock of eco-activists as thousands of them under the banner of Global Forum descended on Rio and lent both the other voice and colour to the gathering. There was an element of fun too with demonstrators taking the opportunity to cavort in the flimsiest of bikinis—as thin as dental floss—at Rio's famed beaches to make a statement about global warming. Behind the hip, hype and the hoopla, the Rio Summit was to get world leaders to agree on an urgent action plan to significantly cut down carbon-dioxide emissions, save the world's forests, preserve biodiversity and help poor

RAJ CHENGAPPA : www.indiatodayimages.com

ENTHUSIASTIC SUPPORTERS AT THE SUMMIT



nations combat climate change. Typically as they are doing now in Copenhagen, the rich nations promised much but delivered little. Industrialised countries dragged their feet over binding emission cuts and provisions to give funding and clean technology to poor nations to help them combat climate change. The US, then the world's biggest emitter of greenhouse gases, stood isolated. Finally, a framework agreement on climate change was reached at Rio that would take another five years to become the Kyoto Protocol in 1997 and another eight to come into effect in 2005. Copenhagen was to make corrections in the course. Sadly, history is repeating itself.

by Raj Chengappa

THE FRAMEWORK AGREEMENT OF RIO TOOK FIVE MORE YEARS TO BECOME THE KYOTO PROTOCOL

Top
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Inspiration Theories

Sanjay Gandhi's Death (1980) The Congress and Opposition suspected the other was responsible.

Pavagada Wolves (1983) Congress and Janata Party blamed each other as wolves carried off children.

Air India Bombing (1985) Some Khalistan separatists suspected Indian intelligence had engineered it.

Parveen Babi (1992) She believed Amitabh Bachchan ran the underworld. Was suffering from schizophrenia.

Plague from NATO Lab (1994) "Imperialistic forces" were widely suspected to be behind the Surat plague.